

The Content Continuum

2026

Content Supply Chain POV & Value Prop

GTM INITIATIVES

AGENDA

Narrative 4

Offerings 15

Client Stories 21

Marketing & Enablement 29

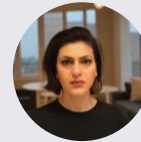
MEET THE TEAM



Ed Forman
Executive Sponsor
Chief Growth Architect



Michelle Cascone
Full-time Initiative Lead
VP Growth Architect



Ilona Yeremova
Sales Enablement Lead
Sr. Director DX Biz Dev



Megan Munoz
Marketing Lead
Sr. Manager Tech Strategy



Sayantika Sikdar
Analytics Lead
VP Analytics Solutions



Natasha Ness
Solutions Lead
Adobe Alliance Solutions

What is Content Supply Chain in 2026?

A quick CSC 2025 refresher

Let's say you're a global camping equipment brand, with 5 products...



How much content do you need to effectively market your business?

5

products



4

personas



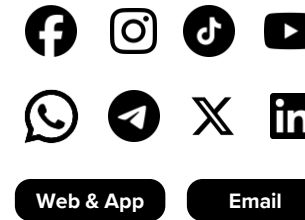
12

campaigns/year



10

channels



50

global markets



...with 5 different
units per channel

600,000 assets

And at this point, most brands face one of two problems...

**THEY TRY
TO MAKE**

600k

ASSETS

- !! It's hugely expensive
- !! It breaks their org & systems
- !! It slows their speed to market

**THEY REUSE THE SAME
CREATIVE ACROSS**

10+

CHANNELS & 50+ MARKETS

- !! Making optimization impossible
- !! Reducing consumer engagement
- !! Killing media ROI & effectiveness

And that's just getting the basics right.

- It's before you get to multi-variate testing at multiple levels of concern
- It's before you consider the emergence of generative, variation

It's a Multiplicative Problem:

600,000 x 5, 10, 15

= Infinite, Endless, Constantly Growing Estate of Content

More content than ever is needed to drive experiences



With Dynamic Optimization



Across **50** Global Markets



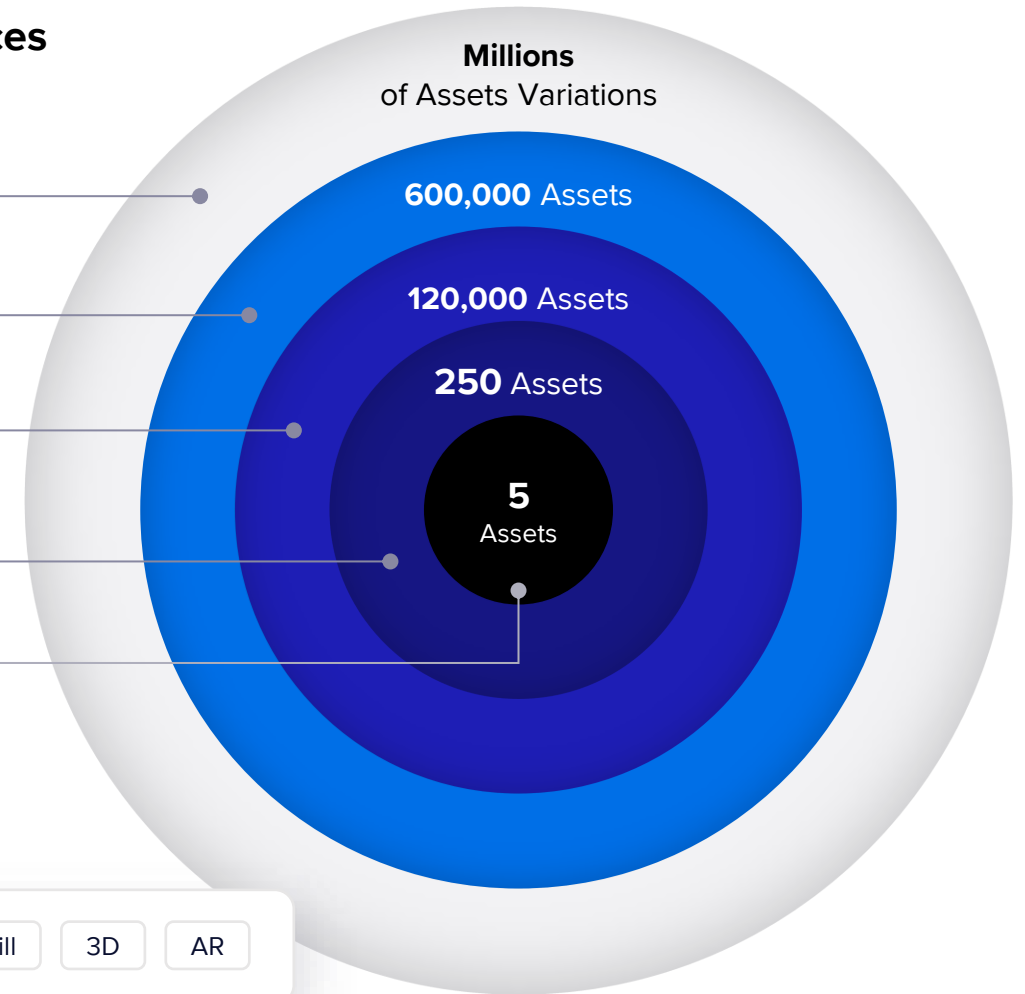
For **4** Personas, Supporting 12 Campaigns



For **10** Channels, with **5** Units Per Channel



5 Products



MERKLE'S 2026 POV

**CSC VALUE REALIZATION =
CHANGE & ADOPTION**

BILLIONS INVESTED IN CSC TECH

55%

of marketing leaders **report a gap**
between **technology expectations and**
reality

40%

average shortfall, among
those leaders

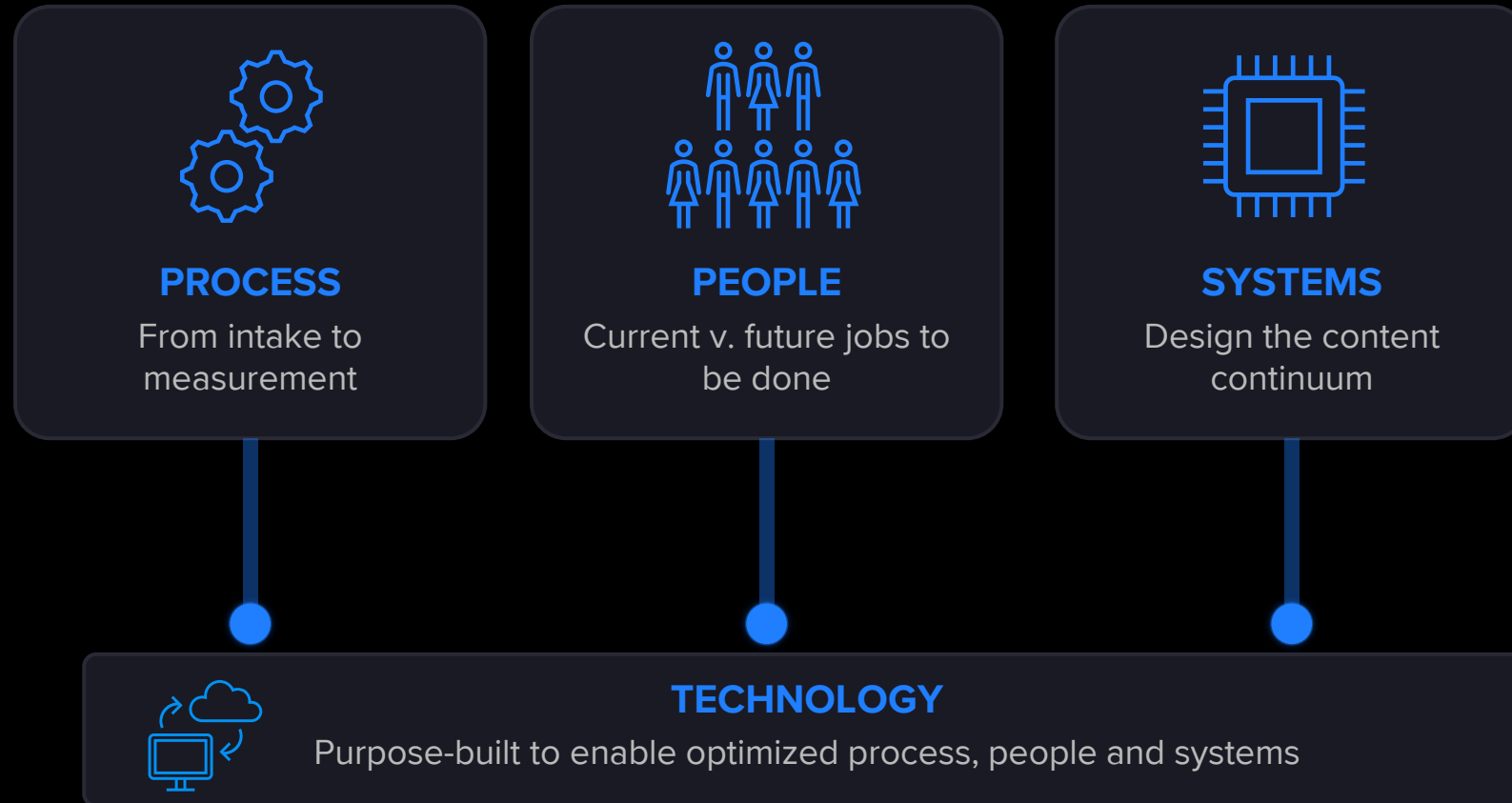
THE UPSIDE IS ALREADY THERE

Only
49%

of martech capabilities are actively
being used today

IT'S WAITING FOR THE ORGANIZATION TO CATCH UP

Our clients are asking us to **optimize their CSC technology implementations** when they need to **also address the people, systems, and processes around them**



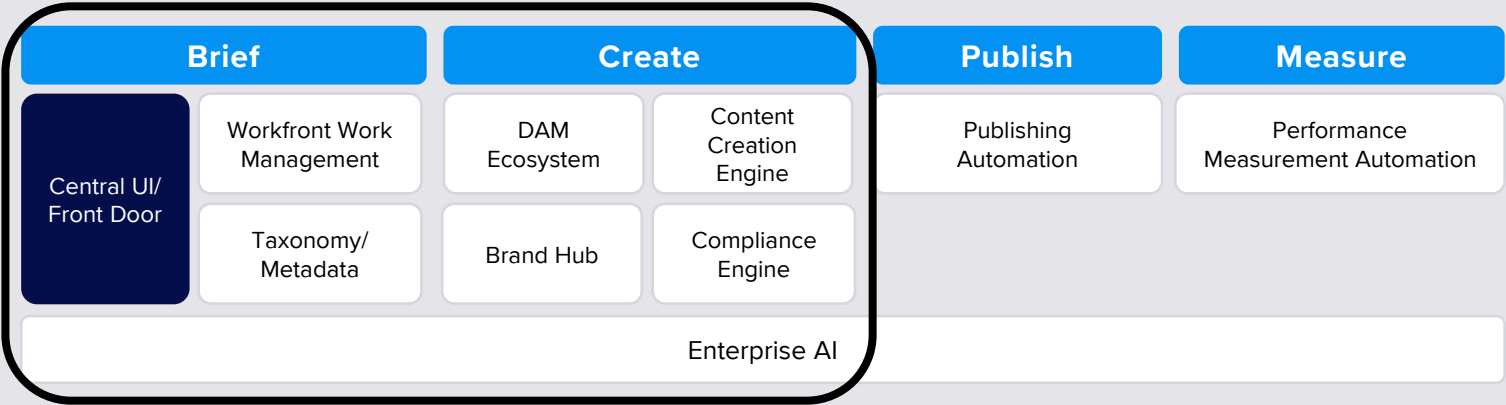
CSC plays a key role in the Enterprise Marketing OS

MARKETING OPERATING SYSTEM FRAMEWORK

Outbound Engagement channels



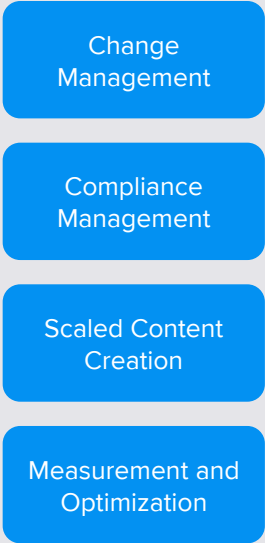
EXPERIENCE SUPPLY CHAIN



Upstream

- Campaign Briefs
- Channel Templates
- Figma
- Google Assets

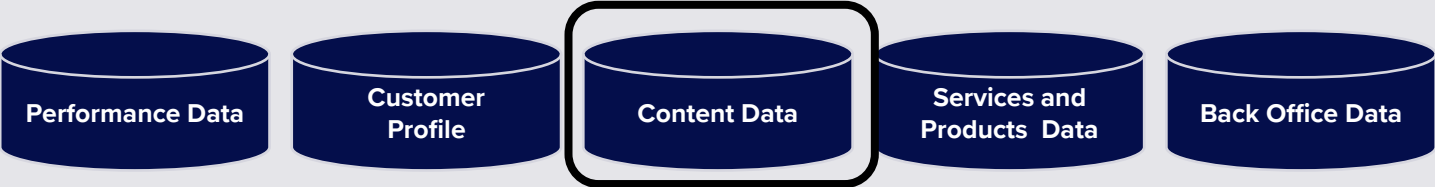
EXPERTISE



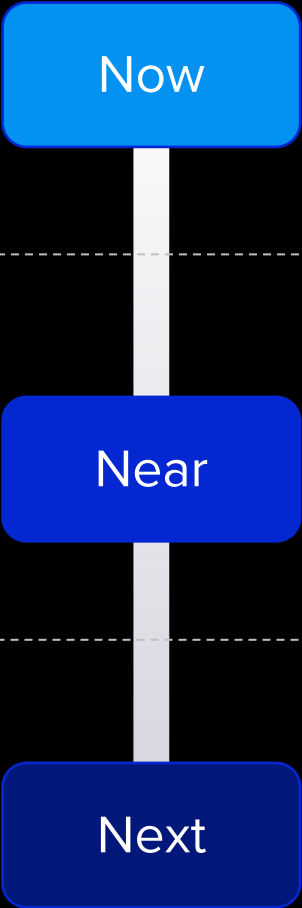
Upstream

- Enterprise Campaign Taxonomy Schema
- Enriched Metadata
- Efficiency KPIs
- Performance KPIs

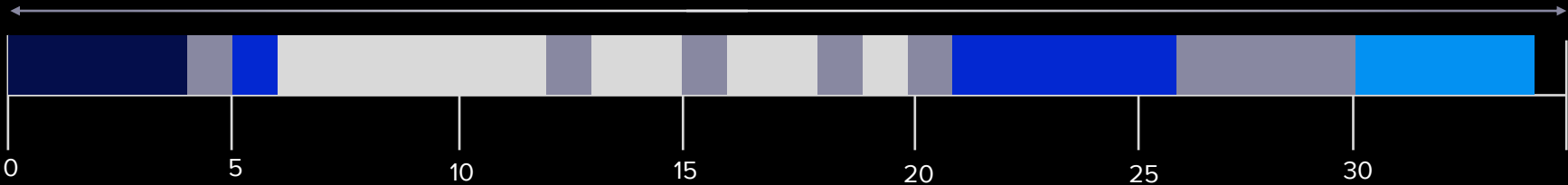
DATA FABRIC



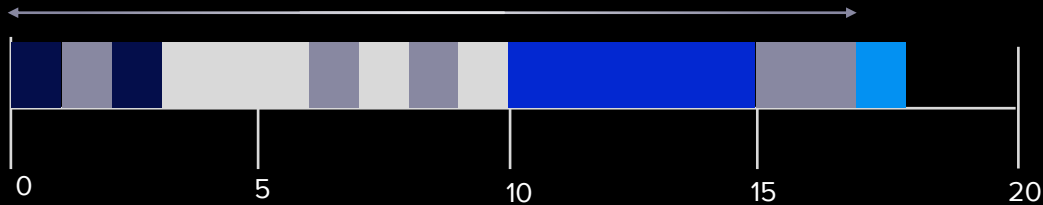
We need to think about CSC across a Now. Near. Next. horizon



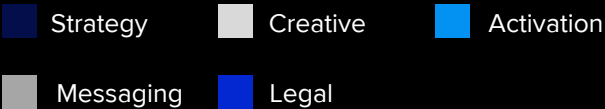
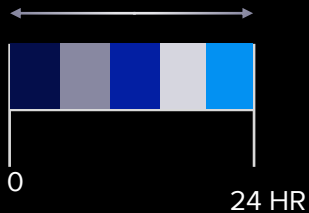
Teams spend time chasing handoffs and approvals.



AI and automation unlock momentum and empower strategy.



Turning ideas into action in hours, not weeks.



Two Merkle Client Profiles across Buy Build Borrow

External Agency Model

BUY

External Agency Model

AOR services
dentsu Creative,
Media, and/or TAG

BUILD

If dentsu AOR,
GenStudio dentsu+

BORROW

This is our One Dentsu
unique advantage.
We are an agency using
what we build everyday.

Client Investment

Ex: GenStudio

Internal use case examples:
Searchable asset hub
CRM at scale
Field-based self-service

We continually infuse
best practices.

Two Merkle Client Profiles across Buy Build Borrow

Internal Agency Model

BUY

Example, not
limited to Adobe:
GenStudio

BUILD

Enterprise grade, purpose-fit E2E
solution delivering against example
use cases:
Unified intake, review & approval
AI creative production
Searchable asset hub
CRM at scale
Field-based self-service

BORROW

This is our One Dentsu
unique advantage.
We are an agency
using what we build
everyday.

We continually infuse
best practices.

Investment

What's next for CSC?

2026

Content Supply Chain technologies are purchased; **success requires tackling adoption & value realization** to create a durable competitive advantage

THE CLIENT IMPERATIVE

Whole-org Change & Adoption: early movers are redesigning the work – not just the tools – building organizational muscle memory

Bottom-line Value Realization: intelligence at every altitude earns trust and delivers business results

2030

Content Supply Chain is a **commodity**; brands large and small have access to dynamic content supply chains across a variety of tools and platforms

Brands who have not operationalized a content supply chain will lose share to the competition, with higher costs and reduced effectiveness

Merkle delivers what system integrators and traditional agencies can't: marketing transformation expertise paired with enterprise technology depth.

We build modern marketing operating systems that deploy compliant, culturally relevant campaigns at market speed through proven technology, custom development, and agency excellence – simultaneously.

What makes us different:

- **Marketing-first technologists** – Business value and creative expertise drive our technology decisions
- **Enterprise transformation rigor** – CSC platform depth, AI methodology, and change management capabilities agencies lack
- **Bilingual execution** – We speak both IT and Marketing, eliminating translation gaps and delivering integrated solutions

The Merkle Difference

	 MERKLE	CONSULTING FIRMS	AGENCIES	SYSTEM INTEGRATORS
	Cohesive full growth services	Strategic advisory, fragmented (sometimes outsourced) delivery	Marketing and creative heritage, basic technology implementation	Tactical implementation, lack of strategic/marketing capability
Outcome Focused Change Management				
Marketing/ Creative Experts With AI Toolset Expertise				
Scaled Global Content Production				
Technology Integration and Adoption				

CSC offerings Build + Activate

Who is buying Content Supply Chain and why?

CMO

- **Safely Creating AI-Accelerated Content with Intention** by creating the right content within regulatory and privacy requirements
- **Controlling Costs** by reducing reliance on external agencies
- **Doing More with Less/Same Budget** - Localization and infinite variation, while staying on brand and message

CTO

- **Centralized Hub and Spoke** to streamline, centralize, and unify for efficiency
- **Value Realization of Connected Platform** - making the most of your platform investments

Cross-Functional

- **Content Velocity** to shorten creative and approval process; time to value
- **Content Analytics and Optimization** for balancing content creation (net new vs. reuse for efficiency)
- **Change, Operating Model, and Transformation Management** - rallying the enterprise around new ways of working through people, process, and technology adoption

WHAT ARE WE SELLING?

Merkle's CSC Build Engagements

BUILD

Who: Enterprises looking to scale AI-enabled content operations

What: Transform a brand's content process, systems & people on a data-first technology spine

Why: Exponential growth in content demand & desire to leverage AI in content production

Strategy	DX	Strategy	Strategy
Analytics & Insights	DX	DX	DX
Analytics & Insights	Analytics & Insights	Analytics & Insights	Analytics & Insights
COE Program Management	COE Program Management	COE Program Management	COE Program Management
WEDGE CSC Blueprint	ENGAGEMENT Innovation Accelerator	ENGAGEMENT Turnaround & Recovery	ENGAGEMENT Enterprise Transformation
Work orch + MarTech evaluation + future roadmap	Rapid pilot experimentation sprints	Optimize in-process implementations + adoption	End-to-end platform design, implementation & change management
2-4 months Investment: \$350k-\$500k	9-12 months Investment: \$700k-\$1.5M	5-12 Months Investment: \$500k-\$2M	2-5 Years \$5M/year
CMO, SVP/VP Mktg Ops	CMO, CTO, VP/Dir Mktg Ops	SVP/VP Mktg Ops, Tech Ops	CEO, CMO, CTO
Current State Assessment- Quant Maturity Model + People, Process & Tech observations	Use case definition and success criteria	Operational diagnostic and root cause analysis	Program governance framework and PMO structure
Target State Operating Model Target State Process Maps	Pilot platform configuration	Stabilization plan and immediate remediation	Enterprise platform implementation
Key Observations and Themes	Workflow design and implementation	Recovery roadmap with milestones with re-baselined success metrics	Content data fabric architecture
Future State Prioritized Initiative roadmap	AI content production proof of concept	Executive governance and decision-rights reset	Organizational change management program
Business case for Transformation investment	Performance measurement framework	Team realignment and role clarification	AI adoption and governance framework
	Scale readiness assessment and recommendations	Adoption Recovery and targeted enablement	Vendor coordination and integration management

WHAT ARE WE SELLING?

Merkle's CSC Activate Engagements

ACTIVATE

Who: Enterprises operating a modern content ecosystem & not realizing desired value

What: Optimize a brand's content continuum with closed-loop insights & managed services

Why: Ensure enterprise's CSC evolves at the speed of automation, ai, and agentic capabilities

Strategy	Strategy
DX	DX
Analytics & Insights	Analytics & Insights
COE Program Management	COE Program Management
WEDGE Platform Value Realization	ENGAGEMENT Continuous Value Accelerator
Optimize in-process program for closed-loop measurement & enterprise adoption	Anchored with a PMO, this is CSC Run & Optimize
3-8 Months Investment: \$400-800k	2-5 Years \$5M/year
SVP/VP Mktg Ops, Tech Ops	CEO, CMO, CTO
Adoption barrier diagnostic	Enterprise Adoption Program
Current State Workflow	Continuous Optimization Roadmap
Embedded enablement opportunities	Performance Analytics Dashboard
Governance framework	AI Enhancement Plan
Platform champion training	Knowledge Transfer Documentation
Stabilization metrics dashboard (BVA)	

Client stories

From Foundation to Flight: Building Your AI-Ready CSC Engine

Merkle's Presentation for Highmark Health's CSC Modernization

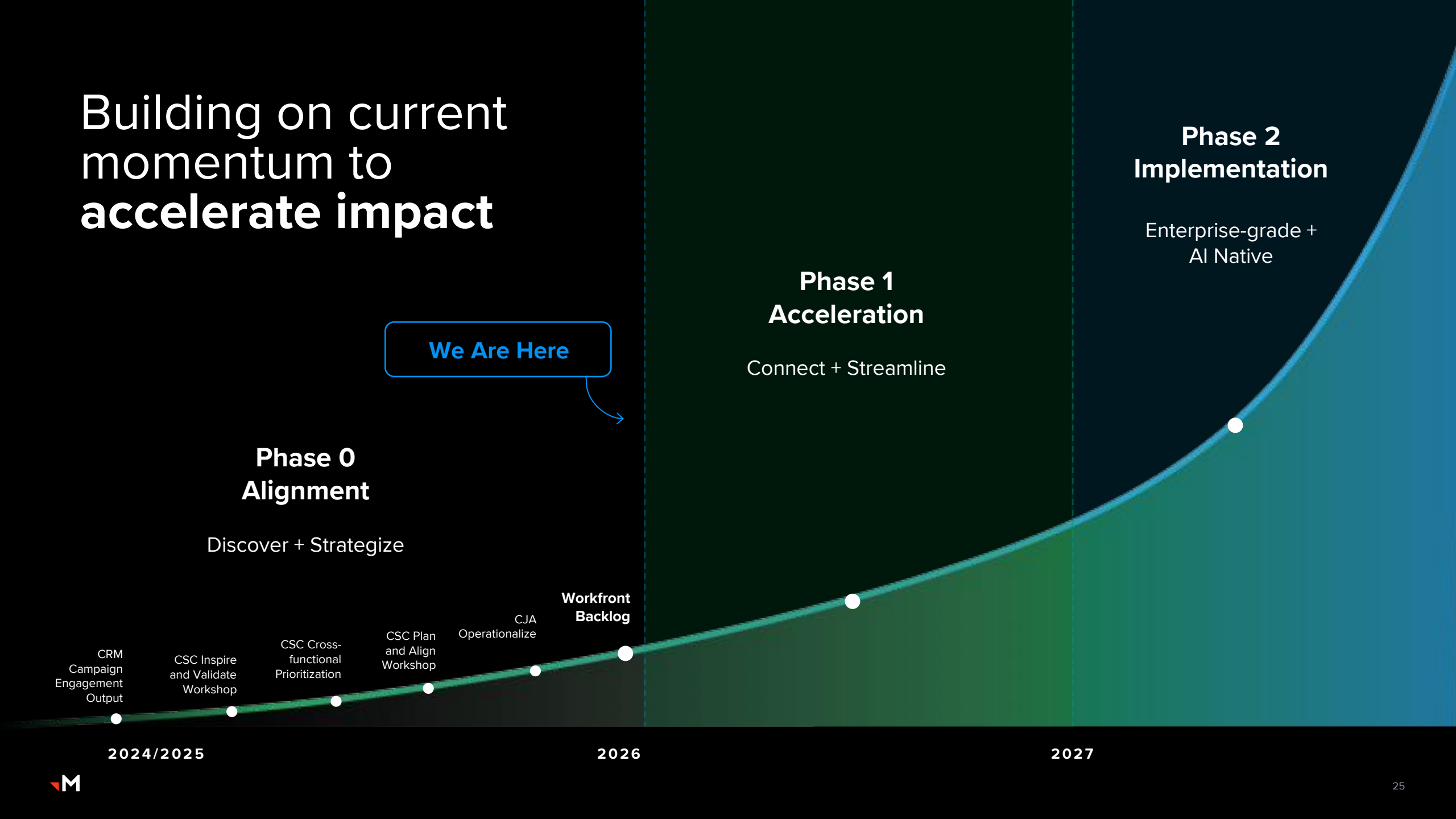
FEBRUARY 18, 2026



Whole-organization change



Building on current momentum to **accelerate impact**



Soon, Highmark will be on a more efficient and effective operating system for marketing across business units and customers, at scale

Why Merkle

We’ve already done the work

Merkle built your Content Supply Chain blueprint. We’re not learning your business; we’re ready to operationalize it.

We know what breaks

We’ve implemented agentic workflows in regulated environments. We know what compliance demands and what adoption requires.

We build to transfer

No endless ‘knowledge transfer’ billings. Your team owns the operation. We leave you stronger, not dependent.

We’re ready. Are you?



PHASE 1 DELIVERABLES

Workstream 0.5: Alignment

- Business Case with board-ready ROI model
- Transition Plan with risk mitigation
- Change Management Plan for 97+ FTE adoption

Workstream 1-6: Core Capabilities & AI Foundation

- End-to-End Process Optimization (target: 47-day cycle to 15 days)
- Business Rule Standardization across Tonic, enGen, MX, etc.
- Enterprise Role Clarity & RACI for 12+ reviewer workflows
- Content and Asset Management Optimization (5 Dams to Tenovos hub)
- Brand Guidelines, Metadata, and Taxonomy Systemization
- Improved Workfront Integrations
- AI Enablement: From isolated pilots to governed, scalable automation

Target Outcomes

Metric	Current	Target
Cycle time	45-60 days	<15 days
Asset Reuse	~15%	60-75%
AI automation	Pilots	Governed

THE INVESTMENT & RETURN

Phase 1 Investment	\$4.2M
Year 1 Value	1.6M
Year 2+ Annual Savings	\$5.4M-\$8.9M
5-Year Total Value	\$41M
Payback Period	28 months

- ✓ **Dedicated on-shore team**
No rotation, no ramp-up tax
- ✓ **Fixed accountability**
Named leaders from kickoff through optimization
- ✓ **Deliverables aligned to measurable outcomes**
Not activities but results
- ✓ **Human at the Helm governance**
AI that empowers, with your people in control

ROI: Built from your reality

\$21.7M

Net benefit over five years

149% ROI

Month 28 break-even

Built from 12 months of Workfront time tracking + Marketing Team Roster + Budget files. Every assumption traceable to Highmark sources.



HIGHMARK DATA

200,000 CSC-influenced hours

(Tonic creative production: 179K + adjacent marketing operations)

RATES

\$67/hr validated from budget

\$65/hr modeled (conservative)

PRIORITIES

Foundation → AI

Conservative Y1 Capture (20%)

BASELINE

12,802 units of production annually

(campaigns, projects, assets, and deliverables)

179K hours tracked in Tonic Workflows

98 monthly average contributors

(within Tonic's 151-person organization)

New Chat +

 ROI Dashboard Pinned Discussions Workflows

Quick Links

Workfront Salesforce Marketing Salesforce Intelligence Brand Library Design System Compliance Guidelines  My Profile Notifications Settings Evaluate Mode ▾

Where would you like support today?



Campaign Performance

Forecast Media Spend

Predict ROI

Assess Campaign Idea

This is an AI Agentic side-kick made custom for Highmark employees. The results of your queries are driven by your integrated technology, data, governance, and processes.



BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Building an Enterprise Content Engine for Cruise Marketing

What started as a focused Phase 1 CSC blueprint expanded into a full transformation vision with

\$5.7M in identified value through Phase 2

WHAT MADE THIS ENGAGEMENT DIFFERENT

- Merkle's Adobe partnership & GenStudio dentsu+ credentials gave us a distinct edge in the competitive RFP.
- Proves Merkle can lead end-to-end CSC transformation from strategy through implementation by uniting disciplines around one delivery.
- **Highly** collaborative amongst Merkle teams:

Technology Strategy

Digital Experience (DX)

BVA

Operations Strategy

Enterprise Architecture

Intelligent Work Orchestration

“Merkle helped us see the full picture — from fragmented tools to a unified content engine that unlocks real value.”

- Princess Cruise Lines, Marketing Operations

THE ORIGINAL ASK / PITCH

CSC Blueprint - 12-week Strategy Engagement

- Use case inventory and prioritization (5–10 total)
- Technology assessment and recommendations
- Operating model assessment and recommendations
- Business benefit analysis and value drivers
- Implementation roadmap

\$345-\$360K

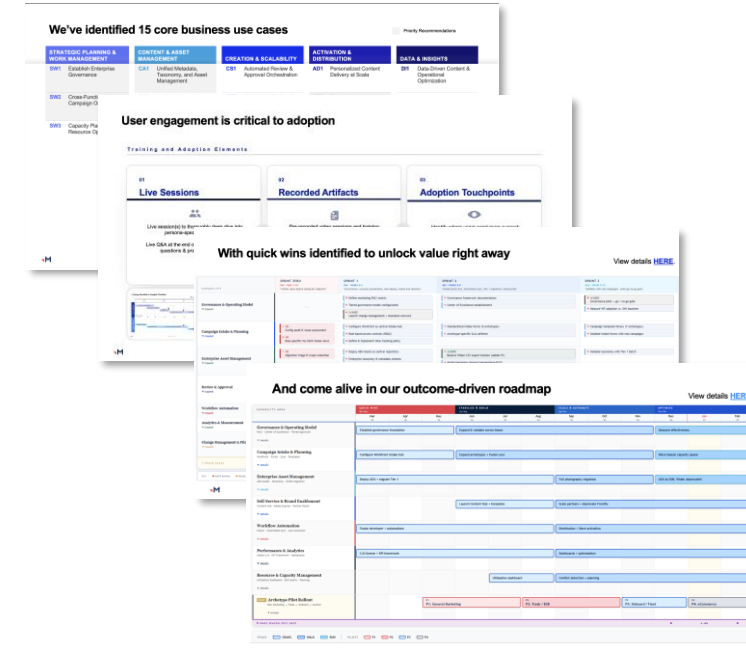
Phase 1 Strategy Engagement



WHAT WE DELIVERED

Full CSC Vision, Roadmap, and Phase 2 Plan

- **15 use cases** defined with crawl-walk-run phasing & dependency mapping
- **Technology assessment & evaluations:** AEM vs. Widen, Express vs. Canva, Content Hub vs. Frontify
- **Enterprise governance**, taxonomy, and metadata remediation strategy
- **End-to-end CSC design** using Workfront, AEM Assets, Creative Cloud, & Adobe Express.
- **Change management framework** with adoption approach & stakeholder alignment
- **Phase roadmap** with quick wins: \$486K year-one, scaling to \$2.2M at full adoption



\$5.7M

Annual operational value identified

\$486K

Year-one quick wins identified

\$134K

CX opportunity unlocked

Marketing & enablement

What to listen for

Clients often present a **symptom** (a tool need, a workflow bottleneck, a channel problem) when the real issue is **systemic**. When speaking to clients, **listen for friction in the content continuum** that reveals disconnects across people, process, and technology.

	Pain Point	Friction	Solution	Value	Client
01	"We want to move to the cloud (AEM on prem) but don't know where to start"	No governance model, fragmented ownership across teams, unclear migration path	AEM Cloud + Workfront for structured intake, workflow, and content governance	Reduced risk, faster time-to-launch, scalable foundation for future content ops	Vanguard
02	"Our DAM isn't working for us — no one's using it and if they are using it, it's still a mess"	Assets are recreated constantly because teams can't find what exists; metadata is inconsistent and files still live all over the place	AEM Assets + AI-powered tagging and search; DAM governance workshop to align taxonomy	Fewer redundant asset requests, faster campaign turnaround, brand consistency at scale	Princess
03	"Each team uses their own tools — Excel, Jira, Trello — to manage work"	No shared visibility into who's doing what; handoffs break down; launch timelines slip	Workfront as enterprise work management layer; integrations to existing martech stack	Single source of truth for campaign status; leadership visibility without status meetings	Highmark
04	"By the time content goes through review, the strategy has already changed"	Manual review cycles with no SLAs; multiple stakeholders touching assets with no version control	Workfront proofing + AEM workflow automation to enforce review stages and deadlines	30–50% reduction in review cycle time; fewer revision rounds; on-time launches	Highmark
05	"We can't personalize at the scale the business is asking for"	Content isn't structured for reuse; no decisioning engine; personalization = manual effort	Adobe Experience Platform + AJO for real-time decisioning; AEM for structured content fragments	1:1 personalization at scale; improved conversion; reduced production burden	Vanguard
06	"We don't know what content is performing — or why"	Analytics, CRM, and DAM are siloed; no asset-to-outcome traceability; ROI story is guesswork	Adobe CDP + CJA to unify data; Build and deploy asset performance dashboards tied to campaign outcomes, assessing content value in AEM, DAM, AJO	Clear ROI story for content investment; smarter budget allocation; faster optimization	Highmark
07	"We can't personalize globally — everyone sees the same experience"	No customer data connected to web delivery; no decisioning layer; personalization requires dev every time	AEP + AEM + Target for real-time segmentation and experience delivery by locale and persona. Create review processes by market owner/coordinator/legal through Workfront Proofing, utilize AI model to build and modify translations	Relevant experiences per market; increased engagement; teams manage personalization without dev	Lumen
08	"We bought Firefly, Express, and GenStudio and no one is using it — and we've lost faith in the solution based on the initial outputs"	Low adoption post-launch; no governance or enablement plan; teams defaulted back to legacy tools; early outputs felt generic and off-brand, eroding stakeholder trust	Merkle-led activation program — brand kit configuration in Express, custom Firefly model training on approved brand assets, and a GenStudio workflow integrated into existing campaign intake	Tools working within brand guardrails from day one; measurable adoption lift; restored confidence through quick wins tied to real campaigns	Microsoft

2026 CSC Initiative: Marketing Plan-on-a-Page

■ Thought Leadership ■ Content Marketing ■ Adoption ■ Assessment ■ Events



Launch: 3/25 (target)
Orchestrating The Content Ecosystem

Playbook
Impact of change management on CSC success

Launch: April
Management Gap

Blog / Vlog
Bridge gaps between leadership and practitioners

Launch: May
Adobe + Merkle: CSC Success Story

Vlog / Blog
Post-Summit engagement and partner alignment

Launch: August
The Hidden Work Killing Content Velocity

Blog
Introduce intelligent work orchestration



Launch: March
From Chaos to Content Supernova

Video
Disconnected vs. unified content operations

Launch: April
CSC Analytics: Buzzword to Bottomline

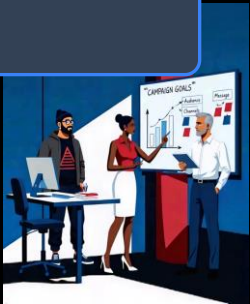
Blog / Vlog
Value of data fabric in the content pipeline

Launch: July
The Adoption Tax

Blog
Bridge gap between CSC tech and adoption barriers

Launch: Sept
CSC Diagnostic

Assessment
Demonstrate proof of concept



Content Supply Chain Diagnostic Opportunity

An interactive 45-question diagnostic that evaluates client content operations across five core areas on a 1 to 5 scale:

1. Creation and Production
2. Workflow and Planning
3. Asset Management
4. Delivery and Activation
5. Data, Reporting, and Insights

Goals:

Establish quantitative baseline of current capabilities

Identify operational gaps

Prioritize improvement initiatives



Content Supply Chain Diagnostic

When you submit this form, it will not automatically collect your details like name and email address unless you provide it yourself.

* Required

ABOUT YOU & YOUR COMPANY

Your Name *

Enter your answer

Your Email *

Enter your answer

Name of the company you represent *

Enter your answer

Region your country is in *

Enter your answer

Industry of your company *

☐ Financial Services

☐ Healthcare & Life Sciences

☐ Media & Entertainment

☐ Travel, Hospitality, & Leisure

☐ Telecommunications

☐ Automotive

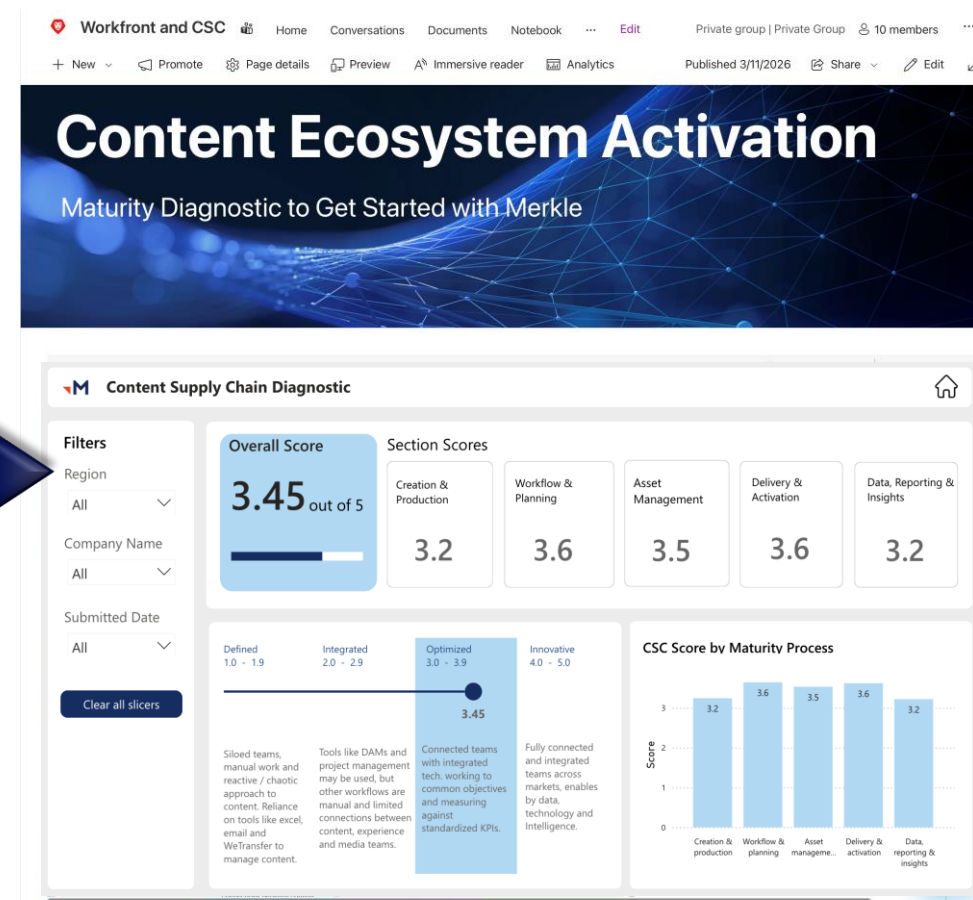
☐ Manufacturing & Industrial

☐ Energy & Utilities

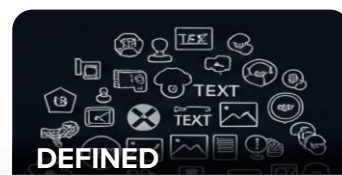
☐ Education

☐ Public Sector / Government

☐ Nonprofit



MATURITY LEVEL SCORES



Score

1.0 - 1.9

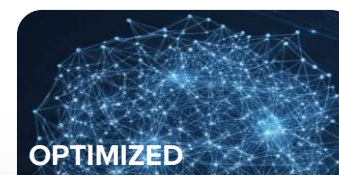
Siloed teams, manual work and reactive / chaotic approach to content. Reliance on tools like excel, email and WeTransfer to manage content.



Score

2.0 - 2.9

Tools like DAMs and project management may be used, but other workflows are manual and limited connections between content, experience and media teams.



Score

3.0 - 3.9

Connected teams with integrated tech, working to common objectives and measuring against standardized KPIs.



Score

4.0 - 5.0

Fully connected and integrated teams across markets, enabled by data, technology, and intelligence, with a growing proportion of work executed by AI agents.

CSC Workshop Solutions

GOAL

LITTLE 'w'

CSC Intro + Maturity Diagnostic

Determine CSC maturity score and establish Merkle as a CSC expert

BIG 'W'

Extended Workshop

Develop use cases & high-level roadmap based on CSC maturity scores across 5 process areas

OUTCOME

Scheduled Full workshop and/or Project Exploration

Prioritized use cases & program scope

DURATION

90 mins

4-8 hours



To schedule CSC workshops, contact:
Michelle Cascone
VP, Growth Architect

Get Ready for Adobe Summit

April 20-22

We have two CSC
items we're
promoting at
Adobe Summit this
year

MAXIMIZING YOUR CONTENT SUPPLY CHAIN INVESTMENT

Path to value realization

MERKLE | Vanguard

PRESENTED BY



Lee Lai
Head of Marketing Operations & Enablement, Personal Wealth Marketing
Vanguard



Ed Forman
EVP, Chief Growth Architect
Merkle



Michelle Cascone
VP, Growth Architect
Merkle

Ed, Michelle, and Lee from Vanguard will be presenting at 1:15pm on 4/20 in the Community Pavilion Theater ([250 people already have signed up!](#))

[Link to session](#)

At the Booth, we will have multiple CSC demos ready to watch so send your customers and prospects over!

Content Supply Chain

Select a demo to explore



GenStudio Dentsu+
Enhanced Adobe GenStudio implementation with Dentsu-specific templates, workflows, and AI models for accelerated content creation.



GenStudio Configuration & Acceleration
Rapid deployment framework for Adobe GenStudio with pre-configured brand guidelines, asset libraries, and approval workflows.



Agentic Digital Content Development
AI agents autonomously creating, optimizing, and distributing digital content across channels based on performance data.



Content Production Pipeline
End-to-end automated pipeline for content ideation, creation, review, approval, and distribution at scale.

Home > Content Supply Chain